

2000-77

COLORADO RARE BIRD REPORT

INCA DOVE
Columbina inca

Red 2/2/01 wpl

Location: Lamar City Park; Lamar, Prowers County, Colorado

Date: April 16, 2000

I was birding with Tony Leukering, Brandon Percival and Chris Wood. Tony spotted this bird first, drew our attention to it, and we all saw it. It was late morning. The light was good. I observed it at a distance of about 50 yards or so with my B & L Elite 10x40 binoculars. Lamar City Park is an open grassy park with scattered large trees but little understory. The Inca Dove sat alone on a branch in a large tree on the edge of an open field, about 40 feet or so off the ground. We saw it perched and in flight.

Description:

The bird was an adult. It was about 8" long. It was slim, long-tailed and small-headed (typical of a dove). It was colored gray overall but was heavily scaled with blackish marks. It did not note eye color but the bill was small and grey. It was pretty unicolored, perhaps a little lighter below. In flight, it had a noticeable rufous flash in the primaries. It had a long, straight, thin tail with white edges.

Similar Species:

The small head, plump body, grey coloration and small bill all indicate a dove. The small size eliminates Mourning and Rock Doves. The heavily scaled upper parts and lack of spots on the wing coverts eliminate Common and Ruddy ground-doves.

Experience with Species:

I have seen many Inca and Ground Doves both in the southwestern part of the United States and in Costa Rica (from 1974-1976). I have seen Inca Doves in Colorado on several occasions.

This report was prepared from notes made after observation.

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